



POLESTAR APAC WEEKLY - 2026-09-20

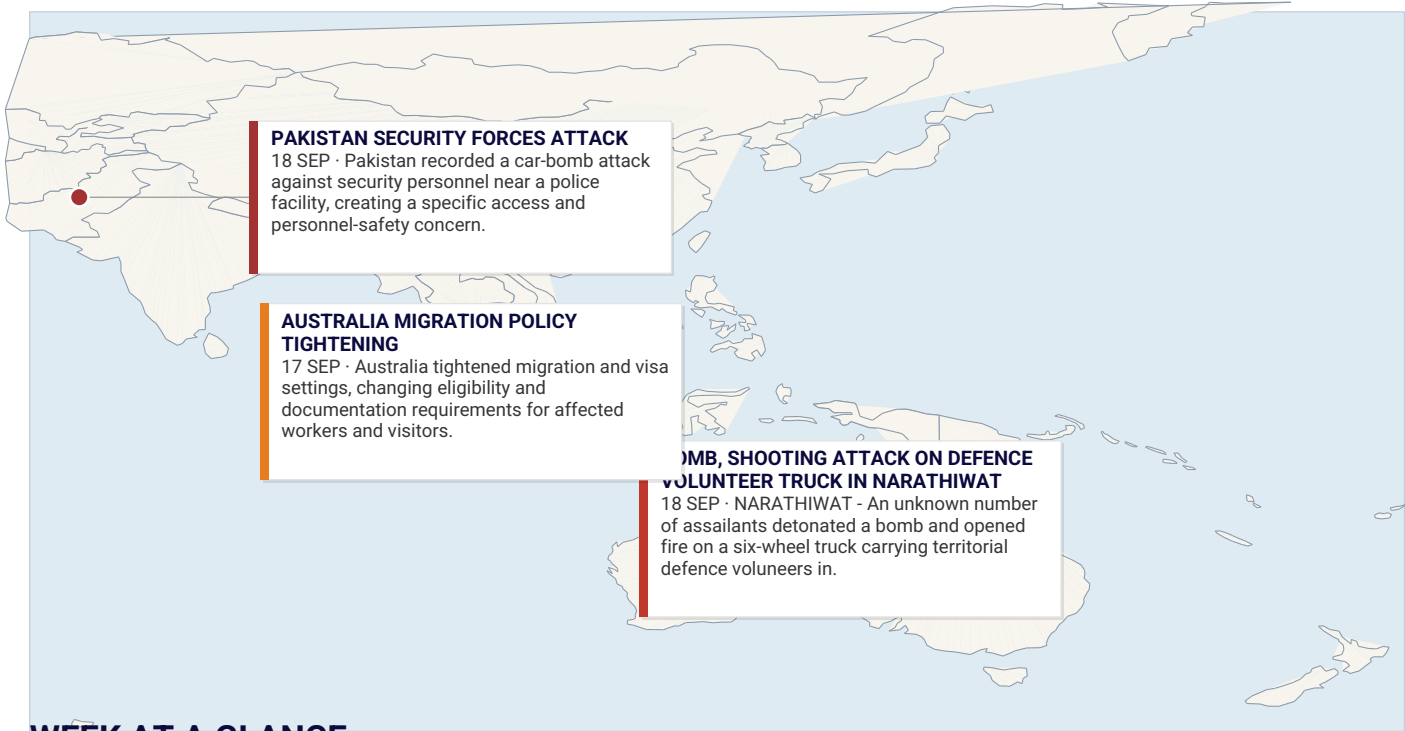
POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 14 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 20 SEPTEMBER 2026

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REGIONAL OUTLOOK

The main APAC judgement this week is that security and conflict, reinforced by political and regulatory change, produced a selective change in business risk rather than a uniform regional deterioration. The curated evidence spans 3 markets and 2 developments reached High or Extreme because current consequences extended beyond routine local inconvenience. Geographic breadth should not be confused with equal exposure: the strongest effects remain tied to particular corridors, facilities, workforce groups and security environments. The developments matter collectively because physical security, access and policy do not operate independently. Violence or protective restrictions can alter movement before they interrupt a site directly; transport and utility constraints can then extend the effect through cargo schedules, suppliers and staffing. Policy measures usually move more slowly, but their reach can exceed that of a local incident once eligibility, documentation or enforcement changes take effect. The resulting picture is mixed: immediate consequence is concentrated, while the potential transmission into regional operations depends on persistence and overlap. For senior decision-makers, this supports differentiated controls. Exposed travel, sites and routes need event-specific decisions, while unaffected markets do not justify a blanket escalation. Continuity planning should test where a local closure, security response or workforce rule would remove a critical alternative. During the next week, the assessment will turn on whether restrictions broaden, recovery stalls, implementation details become binding, or a second event compounds an already constrained route or operating location.



WEEK AT A GLANCE

MATERIAL DEVELOPMENTS 4	MARKETS REQUIRING WATCH 3
HIGH OR EXTREME DEVELOPMENTS 2	7-DAY WATCH ITEMS 1

REGIONAL RISK PICTURE

The principal operating dynamic is the interaction between localised disruption and regional dependence. Security deterioration is concentrated around particular sites and routes, but its business consequence grows when it changes traveller confidence, triggers protective restrictions or interrupts access to commercial facilities. Continuity exposure is currently driven more by local operating conditions than by a region-wide infrastructure shock. Regulatory and political developments operate differently. They may carry lower immediate severity than a physical incident while affecting a wider population through compliance, visa, labour or market-access rules; implementation dates and enforcement practice therefore matter more than headline prominence. Taken together, the evidence supports targeted controls rather than a blanket regional posture: protect exposed journeys and sites, preserve routing alternatives, and distinguish a confirmed operating change from a possibility that has not yet materialised. The risk picture would worsen if local effects persisted, spread to transport or utilities, or coincided with a forward event that reduced recovery capacity.

DEVELOPMENTS BY TYPE



DEVELOPMENTS BY MARKET



KEY DEVELOPMENTS

Pakistan | Pakistan
18 Sep 2026
Pakistan security forces attack

Category: Armed Conflict
Current Severity: Extreme
Assessment: Pakistan recorded a car-bomb attack against security personnel near a police facility, creating a specific access and personnel-safety concern. Polestar View: The event is most consequential if follow-on security measures restrict access around Pakistan, disrupt nearby operations or indicate a wider pattern rather than a contained incident.
Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: track security notices for Pakistan, repeat attacks, access restrictions, casualty updates and any confirmed effect on nearby transport or operating sites.

4 corroborating sources

Australia | Australia
17 Sep 2026
Australia migration policy tightening

Category: Regulatory
Current Severity: Moderate
Assessment: Australia tightened migration and visa settings, changing eligibility and documentation requirements for affected workers and visitors. Polestar View: This is a transition risk: the business effect will be set by the implementation timetable and the practical interpretation of new eligibility rules.
Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: watch official implementation guidance, employer-facing instructions and any change to the effective timetable.

7 corroborating sources

Thailand | Narathiwat
18 Sep 2026
Bomb, shooting attack on defence volunteer truck in Narathiwat

Category: Armed Conflict
Current Severity: High
Assessment: NARATHIWAT - An unknown number of assailants detonated a bomb and opened fire on a six-wheel truck carrying territorial defence volunteers in Sukhirin district of this southern border province on Friday afternoon. Polestar View: The event is most consequential if follow-on security measures restrict access around Narathiwat, disrupt nearby operations or indicate a wider pattern rather than a contained incident.
Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: track security notices for Narathiwat, repeat attacks, access restrictions, casualty updates and any confirmed effect on nearby transport or operating sites.

Australia | Australia
17 Sep 2026
Migration policy changes workforce access

Category: Regulatory
Current Severity: Moderate
Assessment: Australia tightens Working Holiday Maker visa extension TravelMole Citrus Australia warning over working holiday visa caps Fruitnet Polestar View: This is a transition risk: the business effect will be set by the implementation timetable and the practical interpretation of new eligibility rules.
Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: watch official implementation guidance, employer-facing instructions and any change to the effective timetable.

2 corroborating sources

BUSINESS IMPLICATIONS

The combined intelligence points to a targeted rather than blanket change in the regional operating posture. People and Travel are affected where the immediate exposure is to personnel safety and security-site access; the assessment depends on whether the incident remains contained, prompts new restrictions or produces repeat disruption around the named location.; and the measure changes workforce eligibility, documentation or travel planning; the practical effect depends on the effective rule and affected worker categories. Operations and Assets are affected where the immediate exposure is to personnel safety and security-site access; the assessment depends on whether the incident remains contained, prompts new restrictions or produces repeat disruption around the named location. Regulatory and market-access are affected where the measure changes workforce eligibility, documentation or travel planning; the practical effect depends on the effective rule and affected worker categories. People and travel controls should follow confirmed access restrictions and credible security effects, while operations teams should preserve alternatives for sites, routes and time-critical movements where recovery is uncertain. Supply-chain exposure depends on whether transport or energy disruption persists long enough to affect inventory, cargo timing or supplier reliability. Regulatory and market-access work is broader but generally less severe immediately: businesses should identify affected worker groups, documentation, customs or implementation deadlines before changing operating permissions. These strands are linked by business continuity. A local incident becomes materially more important when it coincides with constrained routing, reduced staffing or a forward event that limits recovery capacity. The appropriate response is therefore evidence-led escalation, not a region-wide assumption of elevated risk.

7 DAY WATCH

2026-09-27 | Islamabad, Pakistan | Supporters of Imran Khan's party to march toward Islamabad on September 27: Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

Movement and access in Islamabad, Pakistan may be affected by the scheduled activity. Current severity: Moderate. Track route and venue advisories, transport changes and police restrictions.

POLESTAR OUTLOOK

The APAC forward risk is most likely to be decided by whether current security pressure remains localised or begins to affect commercial movement, operating sites and transport links. Follow-on attacks, access restrictions, security-force activity and evidence of displacement will determine whether the security picture deteriorates. There is no confirmed region-wide infrastructure disruption, but recovery and access notices remain relevant to exposed operations. Policy developments are a different risk: their severity may be moderate today while their commercial reach expands when implementation guidance, deadlines or enforcement practice becomes clear. The indicators that would change the assessment are Next seven days: track security notices for Pakistan, repeat attacks, access restrictions, casualty updates and any confirmed effect on nearby transport or operating sites. Next seven days: watch official implementation guidance, employer-facing instructions and any change to the effective timetable. Next seven days: track security notices for Narathiwat, repeat attacks, access restrictions, casualty updates and any confirmed effect on nearby transport or operating sites. Next seven days: watch official implementation guidance, employer-facing instructions and any change to the effective timetable..

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